Name:_____ Class:_____ Date:_____

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

Indicate the answer choice that best completes the statement or answers the question.

1.

> "Germany does not want war and is prepared to renounce it absolutely … provided she is given real equality"
> - Philip Kerr, 1935, after meeting with Adolf Hitler
>
> "Germans are only walking into their own back garden"
> - Philip Kerr, 1936, after Germany militarized the Rhineland

Based on the quotes above, the British politician and newspaper editor Philip Kerr was a supporter of which of the following?

a. The limitation of international alliances
b. Expansion of French political influence
c. Militarization of British colonies
d. Appeasement of German ambitions

2.

> "We shall fight on the beaches, we shall fight on the landing grounds, we shall fight in the fields and in the streets, we shall fight in the hills. We shall never surrender."

Which leader inspired soldiers and civilians alike during the early phase of World War II with this quote?

a. Adolf Hitler
b. Winston Churchill
c. Joseph Stalin
d. Franklin D. Roosevelt

3. Which of the following is the best description of the military strategy known as "island hopping" ?

a. The German approach to controlling the Atlantic Ocean by using submarines to defeat the "islands" of American ships there.
b. A combination of US Army, Army Air Force, Marine, and Navy attacks on Japanese held islands in order to reach the Japanese mainland.
c. The method of quickly landing on an island and immediately taking off that was used by the Italian air force to conquer Ethiopia.
d. The American disinformation technique of sending fake trucks and planes to islands all over the Pacific in order to confuse the German military intelligence.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

4.

> "From Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic, an iron curtain has descended across the Continent. Behind that line lie all the capitals of the ancient states of Central and Eastern Europe...The Communist parties, which were very small in all these Eastern States of Europe, have been raised to pre-eminence and power far beyond their numbers and are seeking everywhere to obtain totalitarian control. Police governments are prevailing in nearly every case, and so far, except in Czechoslovakia, there is no true democracy." - Winston Churchill, 1946

What is the best description of the "iron curtain" described in the above quote?

a. The physical barriers created by the Soviet Union in cities such as Berlin to keep citizens from fleeing their territories
b. A political dividing line between free states in Western Europe and the Soviet-controlled states of Central and Eastern Europe
c. A metaphor for the iron-like military rule of the Western powers fighting against the onslaught of Communism
d. The missile defense system established by the Nazis during World War II that had to be disarmed by the Allies

5. The primary goal of the Nazi's implementation of "The Final Solution" was to
   a. commit genocide against the Jewish people and avenge alleged wrongs committed against Germans.
   b. imprison priests, intellectuals, and other civilian leaders that did not follow Nazi ideals.
   c. counter Joseph Stalin's forces in the East before they could establish a foothold in Poland.
   d. transport “inferior races” from conquered lands to Germany to be used as enslaved laborers.

6. The aim of the Soviet Union’s First Five Year Plan was to
   a. build up heavy industry.
   b. acquire foreign capital.
   c. encourage agricultural production by subsidizing kulaks.
   d. put industry in the hands of the proletariat.

7. The Nazi *Einsatzgruppen* were
   a. mobile killing squads tasked with rounding up and murdering Jews in the East following the advance of the army.
   b. elite fighter pilots in the *Luftwaffe*.
   c. concentration camp forces comprised of Jewish captives given additional privileges for policing fellow prisoners.
   d. spies that infiltrated the upper ranks of allied governments and businesses.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

8. What made the Nazi-Soviet Nonaggression Pact, signed in August of 1939, so significant?
   a. It allowed the United States to focus on attacking Russia since Germany was no longer a threat.
   b. It allowed Hitler to avoid putting Germany into a two-front war in Europe.
   c. It meant that the League of Nations would gain more members, including the United States.
   d. It meant that the Soviet Union would not be allowed to participate in World War II.

9. American foreign policy regarding Europe in the 1930's was primarily directed toward
   a. maintaining U.S. neutrality to prevent foreign attack.
   b. supporting the Republicans in the Spanish Civil War.
   c. guaranteeing the safety of the democracies that emerged after WWI.
   d. blocking Fascist aggression to stabilize the world economy.

10. The most notable social effect of the 1923 inflation in Germany was the
    a. encouragement of population shifts from cities to the countryside.
    b. strengthening of the position of women working in the factories.
    c. reduction of social tensions.
    d. depletion of the savings and income of the middle class.

11. One of Joseph Stalin's main priorities after World War II was to
    a. shift the allied focus from Europe to the Pacific.
    b. build a strong democratic government to run his country.
    c. create a public-works projects to help recovery efforts in the Soviet Union.
    d. create a buffer zone to protect the Soviet Union from possible western aggression.

12. A major reason for the fall of France and the failure of Hitler to conquer Britain was that
    a. Hitler deployed more strategic bombers to ensure the quick defeat of France.
    b. the French Air Force and the French Armored Tank Division were smaller than those of the British.
    c. Britain refused to help France when the Germans invaded.
    d. the British utilized modern military technology, especially radar, better than the French.

13. The most consequential accomplishment of the Potsdam Conference in 1945 was
    a. an agreement to divide Germany into 4 different allied occupation zones.
    b. an agreement to allow free elections in all territories formerly occupied by the Axis Powers.
    c. Soviet consent to allow the United States to drop atomic bombs on Japan.
    d. the withdrawal of the Soviet Union from WWII before the defeat of the Axis Powers.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

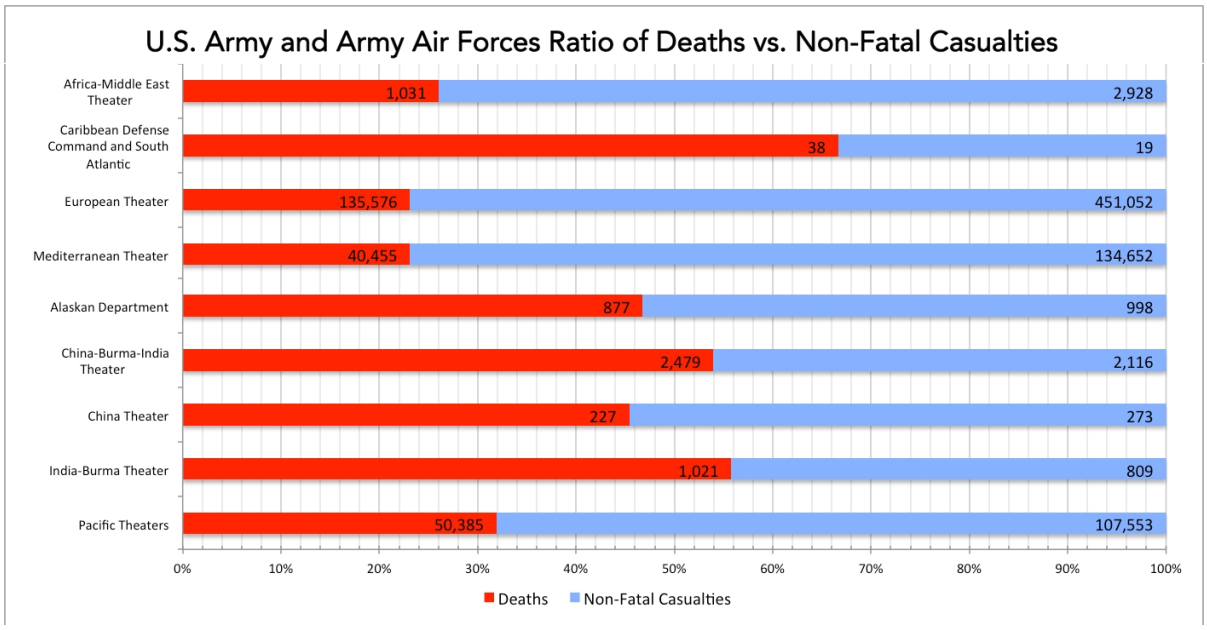
14. Why was the Battle of Stalingrad a key turning point in Germany's invasion of the Soviet Union?
    a. Hitler convinced Joseph Stalin that a German victory was inevitable
    b. It marked the Soviet army's worst defeat of the war
    c. The battle marked the end of German advances into eastern Europe and it was Hitler's first major loss
    d. It provided Hitler with the strategic resources necessary for dominating Europe

15. How did the Great Depression facilitate political changes in Europe that ultimately led to World War II?
    a. The Great Depression increased the value of books, which caused more people to read and gain exciting new political ideas.
    b. The Great Depression caused massive famines and starvation in Germany, which led Germans to invade Poland for food.
    c. The Great Depression made Britain the only wealthy country, since they were isolated from the effects by being an island nation.
    d. The Great Depression led masses of people to follow political leaders who offered simple solutions in return for dictatorial power.

16. Formed after the abdication and exile of Kaiser Wilhelm II at the end of World War I, the German Weimar Republic was created to be a
    a. democracy.
    b. communist collective.
    c. limited monarchy.
    d. fascist dictatorship.

Name:_____ Class:_____ Date:_____

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

17. 

Based on the data in the table above, which theater of World War II resulted in the highest number of deaths for American Army and Army Air Force personnel?

a. Caribbean Defense Command and South Atlantic

b. India-Burma Theater

c. European Theater

d. Pacific Theaters

18. Who was the Italian dictator that seized power after WWI and what was his political philosophy called?

a. Adolf Hitler, Nazism

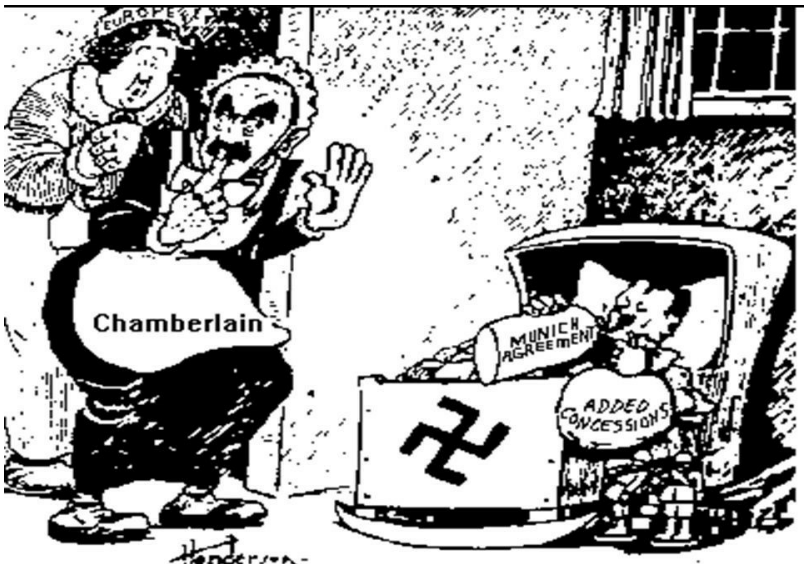
b. Joseph Stalin, Marxism

c. Karl Marx, Marxism

d. Benito Mussolini, Fascism.

Name:_____ Class:_____ Date:_____

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

19. 

This cartoon represents which policy employed by Britain prior to World War II?

a. Warsaw Pact
b. Containment
c. Inflation
d. Appeasement

20. Following British resistance to and retaliation for German air force bombings of military targets on its own soil, Hitler expanded the bombings to target British cities. The ensuing battle for control of the skies was called:
a. The Phony War
b. The Battle of Dunkirk
c. Operation Barbarossa
d. The Battle of Britain

21. A major result of *Kristallnacht* (or the "night of shattered glass") on November 9, 1938 was that
a. thousands of Jewish businesses and synagogues were burned in Germany by the Nazis.
b. Stalin and The Soviet Union allied themselves with Nazi Germany and against the western powers.
c. Hitler's power came into question as his rivals in the Nazi leadership attempted to assassinate him.
d. allied bombings destroyed civilian structures in major German cities such as Berlin.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

22. 

The painter of this piece, working in the early years of the twentieth century, was

a. rebelling against conventional cultural norms.

b. copying the Baroque style.

c. rebelling against surrealism.

d. incapable of accurate draftsmanship.

23.

"I remember the fear, of never feeling safe. You had to hide constantly. And the hunger — I would sit in our apartment and look out the window, and I would see the Polish children across the street bringing milk back home. It was like watching people in a storybook — we had no food, no milk. German soldiers were everywhere. All the Jews had to live behind high walls and barbed wire." -Nelly Casana, Holocaust survivor

The above quote describes life in

a. Dresden during the firebombing.

b. the Dachau concentration camp.

c. London during the siege.

d. the Warsaw Ghetto.

24. The American project to develop atomic weapons during World War II is known as

a. The Manhattan Project.

b. The Iron Curtain.

c. The Secret City.

d. Operation Overlord.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

25. Which of the following nations was NOT included among the "Big Three" at the end of the war conferences?
    a. The Soviet Union
    b. The United States
    c. France
    d. Great Britain

26. 

What was the purpose of the propaganda shown in the image above?
    a. To discourage people from using public transportation, to prevent them from speaking about their jobs.
    b. To encourage people to cut down on fuel use, in order to save it for military efforts.
    c. To encourage people gather as many people as possible to drive to the Army recruitment office.
    d. To discourage people from buying German and Japanese products, in order to hurt their economy.

27. Identify one of the reasons Britain failed to recover economically after the First World War.
    a. A huge loss of property and domestic infrastructure
    b. Currency speculation
    c. Its allies defaulted on war loans
    d. A drastic fall in wheat prices

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

28. In what way did Italy's 1935 invasion of Ethiopia impact relations with other countries?
    a. Italy gained support from the League of Nations, due to its decision to not use gas and other chemical warfare technologies.
    b. More countries joined the League of Nations, due to the strong response from the League over Italy's invasion.
    c. Hitler supported the invasion, causing Mussolini and Germany became closer.
    d. Ethiopia gained direct military support from the League of Nations, due to Emperor Selassie's compelling case against Italian aggression.

29. Nazi leaders accused of crimes against humanity during the war were put on trial by the allies in
    a. Rome
    b. New York City
    c. London
    d. Nuremberg

30. How did the Battle of the Bulge ultimately damage Hitler's efforts in the European Theater?
    a. The battle prevented Japan from invading Australia
    b. The battle prevented the Soviets from sending reinforcements to help the British
    c. It proved the American strategy of island hopping was effective
    d. The battle exhausted German supplies and weakened the German forces

31. The most compelling reason for granting women suffrage in Britain after the First World War was
    a. that there were too few men alive to vote.
    b. gratitude for their letters and parcels sent to men while fighting.
    c. the independence and income they earned after replacing men in factories during the war.
    d. to reward the women who had made significant contributions during the war.

32. While there were concentration camps located throughout territories that were controlled by the Nazis, all of the "death camps" that were designed specifically for the extermination of the Jewish People were in
    a. Poland
    b. France
    c. Germany
    d. Yugoslavia

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

33. 

What does this cartoon depict about Japan during the inter-war years?

a. Anti-Semitism
b. Political incompetence
c. Bolshevism
d. Imperialism

34. The most important impact of the Nuremberg Laws passed by the Nazis in 1935 was that they

a. made all other political parties in Germany illegal.
b. provided government jobs to all unemployed German citizens.
c. stripped Jewish Germans of their citizenship and civil rights.
d. prohibited German women of childbearing age to hold jobs outside the home.

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

35. What is one thing that Italy, Germany, and Japan all had in common in the 1930s?
    a. All three countries turned toward totalitarian governments and made significant attempts to increase military power.
    b. Political elites in all three countries decided to eliminate their emperors in order to make government more efficient.
    c. Leaders in all three countries embraced Catholicism as a way to unify their people under a single religious identity.
    d. All three countries participated in the Spanish Civil War in order to prevent the rise of General Francisco Franco.

36. Which of the following best describes the German "blitzkrieg" strategy?
    a. The use of submarines in the Pacific Ocean to disrupt the shipping of military supplies between Japan and their American allies.
    b. A combination air and ground attack that allowed the German military to attack so quickly that defending troops were unable to effectively respond.
    c. A defensive onslaught involving five or more units, rather than the normal four, which caught the French offensive side off guard.
    d. A slow, methodical approach that employed surprise and sneak attacks, focusing on taking out generals in order to mitigate a numbers disadvantage.

37. Why were both France and Germany interested in controlling the Ruhr valley in the area of the French-German border?
    a. The League of Nations had declared that the country controlling the Ruhr had the right to build nuclear weapons in order to protect the cities there.
    b. The Ruhr was a key mining and industrial area, and both countries were hoping to use the area to help rebuild their own economies after the disastrous First World War.
    c. The area allowed for convenient access to the Mediterranean Sea, which was important because both France and Germany knew that war would begin soon.
    d. The Ruhr river was the last clean source of drinking water in all of Europe, so each country fought desperately to secure the water for their people.

Name:_____ Class:_____ Date:_____

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

38. 

Based on the image above, how did the Versailles treaty increase tension prior to World War II?

a. By giving German land to Poland, some ethnic Germans felt betrayed by the rest of the powers of Europe.
b. By creating a Polish corridor the sea, Germany lost all of its coastal territory.
c. By creating the new German state of East Prussia, other European countries felt nervous that Germany was too powerful.
d. By allowing some areas to vote on whether to remain German, Poles feared that Communism would take over.

39. President Truman's decision to use atomic bombs against Japan was most likely justified by

a. the geography of Japan and its largely unassailable coast lines that ruled out amphibious landings.
b. the extraordinarily large expense of developing the atomic bombs.
c. Japan's progress at developing its own atomic bombs to be used against The United States.
d. the potential loss of far more lives if Americans invaded the Japanese home islands.

40. First voiced on the world diplomatic stage at the Potsdam Conference in 1945, what was the main purpose of the Truman Doctrine?

a. To renew the confidence of the United States populace after the war
b. To prevent the spread of communism throughout the free world
c. To promote U.S. isolationism to and avoid global conflicts
d. To divide Germany into four occupied zones after the war

Name:_____ Class:_____ Date:_____

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

Answer Key

1. d
2. b
3. b
4. b
5. a
6. a
7. a
8. b
9. a
10. d
11. d
12. d
13. a
14. c
15. d
16. a
17. c
18. d
19. d
20. d
21. a
22. a
23. d
24. a
25. c
26. b

WH&G Unit 6 Test: Between the Wars and World War II

27. c

28. c

29. d

30. d

31. c

32. a

33. d

34. c

35. a

36. b

37. b

38. a

39. d

40. b